youth exchange and evolving Comprehensive Economic Partnership in East Asia (CEPEA). With Republic of Korea (RoK) India has started cultivating her relations. The **Long Term Cooperative Partnership** is the bedrock of India-RoK relationship concluded in 2004. With Australia, India is developing closer economic and strategic cooperation. India is negotiating a CECA with Australia. Both interact with ARF, EAS, and Asia-Europe Meeting. India envisions to extend her LEP beyond South-east Asia to East Asia and gradually India is consolidating her relations with these countries.

India also has another interest in successful fruition of LEP. India wants to foster economic development of its North-eastern states by cultivating economic ties with South-east Asian neighbours who are in closer proximity to India's North-eastern frontier. North-east which touches upon the border with Mynamar can be considered as the gateway to ASEAN. India envisions increasing connectivity with her South-eastern neighbours through North-east. To realize this vision, India embarked on projects like the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport facility connecting Indian ports on the eastern sea board to the Sittwe Port in Myanmar and upgradation of the Tamu-Kalewa-Kalemyo Road in Myanmar. Negotiations are going on to establish connectivity between Moreh in Manipur to Mae Sot in Thailand via Bagan in Myanmar. Projects have been undertaken for upgradation of road links too. An ambitious project, if turned into reality, will be a great achievement of LEP is a road link from Jiribham in Assam to Hanoi in Vietnam via Myanmar. ASEAN countries also want to cultivate the huge potential of India's North-east. Laos sees huge potential in North-east's tourism and agricultural sectors. There were visits to North-eastern states in 2007 and 2008 by Thai Minister of Commerce and Thai Deputy Ministry of Industry, to give a further boost to investment and explore potentials of trade. India has issued Visas on Arrival (VoA) to foreign tourists of 10 countries including Indonesia, Singapore, the Philippines, Vietnam, Myanmar, Cambodia, Japan among others.

ASEAN and India share some common interests like combating trans-national terrorism in all its forms like drug trafficking, smuggling; securing Indian Ocean and maritime resources; exploring